

brainstorming assistants, but they're also great reading curators when you give them proper context.

Tell AI the kind of reader you are

Before you ask for recommendations, write a small "reader profile":

- **Genres you enjoy:**
 - Non-fiction: e.g. tech, history, psychology, business, biographies
 - Fiction: e.g. sci-fi, literary, crime, fantasy, romance
- **Attention span & schedule:**
 - "15–20 minutes before bed"
 - "Longer stretches on weekends"
- **Format comfort:**
 - Books vs longform articles vs newsletters vs graphic novels
- **Goals:**
 - "Understand AI & society better"
 - "Read more Indian authors"
 - "Finish 12 books this year"

Prompt template: design your 2026 reading plan

Paste that profile into ChatGPT/Gemini:

Prompt

"Act as my personal reading curator.

Reader profile:

- I like: [genres/topics]
 - I dislike: [things you bounce off]
 - Time: [X minutes/day] + [Y hours on weekends]
 - Goal: [e.g. finish 12 books + keep up with longform essays on tech & society].
1. Propose a 12-month reading roadmap with 1–2 books per month plus 2–3 longform articles.
 2. Mix 'easy win' reads with 2–3 challenging reads across the year.
 3. Mark each item as Light / Medium / Heavy in difficulty.
 4. For each book/article, give a 1–2 line pitch: why I might like it based on my profile."

You'll get a spreadsheet-ready list.

Now ask:

"Turn this into a simple monthly checklist with:

- One main book
- One backup/shorter book
- 2 longform articles
- 1 creative 'dessert' (comic, zine, graphic novel, etc.)."

Copy that into your notes or task manager. That's your Reading Resolutions 2026.

Use AI to fine-tune difficulty

If you find a recommendation too dense:

"I tried reading [book] and found it too heavy. Suggest 3 alternative books that cover similar ideas in a lighter, more story-driven way."

Or if you loved something:

"I loved [book X] because [reason]. Suggest 5 similar books and 5 longform essays that match this vibe, preferably including at least 2 Indian authors."

Over time, you can reuse the same chat, so AI learns your taste and keeps tuning recommendations. Tools like Perplexity are starting to remember preferences across sessions too, which makes this even smoother.

2. Summarise books/articles

Reading more doesn't always mean reading every word. Sometimes "staying in touch" with a topic simply means:

- Skimming a good summary
- Capturing key ideas
- Deciding which books deserve deep reading

Modern AI summarisation uses large language models to compress long texts into concise, coherent versions, preserving key concepts. ChatGPT, Perplexity and similar tools are widely used for this.

Summarising a long article (step-by-step workflow)

Let's say you have a 5,000-word essay open in your browser.

1. Copy the text (or share the URL if the AI tool accepts links).
2. Open Perplexity or ChatGPT.
3. Use a structured prompt:
 - "Summarise the following article for me.
 - First, give a 3-sentence overview.
 - Then, list 7–10 key points.
 - Finally, give 3 'takeaway actions' I can apply in my life/work.
4. Skim the summary.
5. If you want more depth, follow up:

"Turn the key points into a set of 10 flashcards (Q on one side, A on the other) so I can revise this later."

Perplexity is particularly good here because it blends summarisation with web citations, so you can click through to the original sources if you want.

Building a "reading notebook" with AI

Combine human reading + AI notes:

1. Read the article normally for 15–20 minutes.
2. Then ask AI for a summary as above.
3. Copy the key points and flashcards into your note app (Notion, Obsidian, Google Docs).
4. Tag them by topic ("AI ethics", "design", "personal finance").